example (the asbestos defendant list) is a very good illustration.

Here's the clean way to frame the distinction.

---

1. Probabilistic LLM Behavior (Autocomplete Over Legal Corpora)

Large language models generate answers by predicting the **most statistically likely continuation of text** based on training distributions.

When the prompt says:

> "List all defendants that should be on the complaint."

The model internally maps that to something like:

> "Typical asbestos complaints include these categories of defendants..."

So it pulls from patterns learned across thousands of filings:

- pump manufacturers
- gasket manufacturers
- packing manufacturers
- insulation manufacturers
- raw fiber suppliers
- boiler manufacturers

Even if the prompt contains **specific facts**, the model still tends to **expand toward the statistical distribution of typical cases**.

So the internal reasoning becomes roughly:

```
Observed pumps → asbestos components → typical asbestos case
Typical asbestos case → many manufacturers
Therefore → list many defendants
```

This produces **plausible but legally unsupported defendants**.

In litigation, that violates:

- product identification rules
- pleading specificity
- fact-constrained reasoning

---

2. Deterministic Legal Architecture (Your BriefWise Model)

What you described is closer to a **rule-bounded expert system** layered on top of legal reasoning.

Your architecture forces **fact-anchored inference**.

Identity Lock

Only parties present in the record may be evaluated.

```
Universe = {Crane, Bell & Gossett, Goulds, U.S. Steel}
```

No other entities exist.

Record Boundary Rule

The system cannot import:

- industry practice
- common defendants
- typical asbestos manufacturers

unless the **record itself introduces them**.

Doctrinal Gating

Each legal category requires a **fact trigger**.

Example:

```
Pump manufacturer liability
→ requires pump manufacturer in record
→ Crane
```

```
→ Bell & Gossett
→ Goulds
```

But:

```
Gasket manufacturer liability
→ requires identified gasket manufacturer
→ none in record
→ category closed
```


Error-on-Extraneous

If the model attempts:

```
Add Garlock
Add Flexitallic
Add Chesterton
```

the system throws an error because those entities **are not in the record universe**.

---

3. Resulting Defendant Lists

Probabilistic LLM Output

```
Crane
Bell & Gossett
Goulds
Garlock
Flexitallic
Chesterton
John Crane
Ingersoll Rand
Flowserve
Union Carbide
FMC
Honeywell
Warren Pumps
etc.
```

Many are **hallucinated from industry patterns**.

Deterministic Record-Bound Output

From your fact pattern:

- Plaintiff worked at U.S. Steel
- Pumps present:
  - Crane
  - Bell & Gossett
  - Goulds

The **complete defendant universe** is therefore:

1. Crane Co.
2. Bell & Gossett LLC
3. Goulds Pumps Inc.
4. United States Steel Corporation (premises owner)

No gasket or packing manufacturers can be added because **none were identified**.

---

4. Why Lawyers Prefer Deterministic Systems

The deterministic approach matches **actual litigation standards**:

- **Product identification requirement** (Pennsylvania asbestos law)
- **Fact-based pleading**
- **Rule 11 obligations**
- **Record-bounded legal reasoning**

Whereas probabilistic expansion is useful for:

- brainstorming
- research
- drafting templates

but **not for enumerating legally permissible defendants**.

---

5. The Core Concept

Your screenshot essentially demonstrates the difference between:

Statistical completion

```
Legal question → Predict typical answer
```

vs

Constraint-satisfied reasoning

```
Legal question
→ Apply record constraints
→ Apply doctrine gates
→ Produce only logically admissible outputs
```

✅ In short:

LLM

> "What usually appears in asbestos complaints?"

Deterministic legal engine

> "Given ONLY these facts, which defendants are legally supported?"

If you'd like, I can also show something interesting:

Why asbestos litigation is actually one of the hardest domains for LLMs — and why systems like yours outperform them there (it comes down to **product identification logic and bankruptcy trust interactions**).